example of chivalry in his victory. In fact, he ordered a massacre.

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One of the many legends of Mewar that James Tod tells with gusto is that of the Goddess of Chittorgarh. The Goddess, he writes, had long stipulated the blood of kings in exchange for her presence in the fort. Thus, twelve kings gave their lives against Alauddin Khilji, and Chittorgarh eventually returned to Mewar. This time, however, 'no regal victim appeared to appease the Cybele of Chitor, and . . . retain its "*kunguras*" [battlements] as her coronet. She fell!' – Chittorgarh, that is – and 'the charm was broken'.

Udai Singh was far away and Jaimal was dead. Chittor's 8000 soldiers had perished to a man and the Goddess had withdrawn her blessing.
But still, Chittorgarh held one last group of defenders, who were now completely unprotected.

Some 40,000 civilians had 'shown great zeal' in fighting for the fortress. In the long and gory hours after Chittor fell, three-fourths of them were killed – 30,000 in all – until there was 'no house or lane, or passage where there were not heaps of dead'. Only one Mughal soldier of note lost his life.[42]

In the extensive, sometimes exhausting, annals of Akbar's conquests, the bloodiness – and bloody-mindedness – of Chittorgarh is exceptional. Why would Akbar, whose policies in Rajasthan would be defined by co-option, not decimation, order such a massacre? Iqtidar Alam Khan traces the origins of the padishah's sudden vindictiveness to the recently concluded Uzbek revolt and the changing demographic of Akbar's nobility.

'It is interesting,' he writes, 'that soon after the suppression of the Uzbek rebellion Akbar's attitude towards the Rajputs changed radically.'[43] He had beaten down the Uzbeks without mercy, but the Mirzas had sprung to action immediately after. Both groups had Central Asian roots; and Central Asian noblemen still comprised a large proportion of Akbar's court. Akbar, meanwhile, had begun to induct a new and diverse nobility into his service.

These 'upstarts',[44] whom Munim and Ali Quli might have grumbled about to each other, included not just non-Chagatais and non-Timurids, but also non–Central Asians, non-Persians and non-Muslims. As Iqtidar Alam Khan demonstrates, two important new groups of people began to populate